

WE Credit: Outdoor Water Use Reduction

This credit applies to

- ▶ BD+C: New Construction (1-2 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Core & Shell (1-3 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Schools (1-2 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Retail (1-2 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Data Centers (1-2 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Warehouses & Distribution Centers (1-2 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Hospitality (1-2 points)
- ▶ BD+C: Healthcare (1 point)

INTENT

To reduce outdoor potable water consumption and preserve no and low-cost potable water resources.

REQUIREMENTS

NC, CS, SCHOOLS, RETAIL, DATA CENTERS, WAREHOUSES & DISTRIBUTION CENTERS, HOSPITALITY, HEALTHCARE

Reduce outdoor water use through one of the following options. Nonvegetated surfaces, such as permeable or impermeable pavement, should be excluded from landscape area calculations. Athletic fields and playgrounds (if vegetated) and food gardens may be included or excluded at the project team's discretion.

Option 1. No Irrigation Required (2 points except Healthcare and CS, 1 point Healthcare, 3 points CS)

Show that the landscape does not require a permanent irrigation system beyond a maximum two-year establishment period.

OR

Option 2. Reduced Irrigation (1-2 points except Healthcare and CS, 1 point Healthcare, 3 points CS)

Reduce the project's landscape water requirement (LWR) by at least 50% from the calculated baseline for the site's peak watering month. Reductions must first be achieved through plant species selection and irrigation system efficiency as calculated in the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) WaterSense Water Budget Tool.

Additional reductions beyond 30% may be achieved using any combination of efficiency, alternative water sources, and smart scheduling technologies.

Table 1. Points for reducing irrigation water

<i>Percentage reduction from baseline</i>	<i>Points (except Healthcare)</i>	<i>Points (Healthcare)</i>	<i>Points (CS)</i>
50%	1	1	1
75%	--	--	2
100%	2	—	3

GUIDANCE

There are no substantive changes to the credit requirements; refer to the LEED v4 reference guide, with the following additions and modifications:

Behind the Intent**Beta Update**

Core and Shell projects can now earn up to 3 points under WE credit Outdoor Water Use Reduction. One point was re-allocated from WE credit Indoor Water Use Reduction to this credit, to better align WE points available with the typical scope of work of Core and Shell projects and to reward incremental outdoor water use savings.

Further Explanation**Connection to Ongoing Performance**

- ▶ LEED O+M WE credit Water Performance: Designing out the need for a permanent irrigation system, selecting native or adapted plants for project landscaping and/or installing efficient irrigation systems reduces irrigation water use throughout the building life cycle, which may improve a project's water performance score. The use of alternative water systems for irrigation further reduces building potable water use.